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Nationally, rents have been falling for two years now, but in Boston, the median two-bedroom apartment rents for **\$2,446**.

Combination of factors keeps rents soaring

With high-paying jobs, Greater Boston is always popular, but not enough housing

By Andrew Brinker

GLOBE STAFF

Rents in Greater Boston are staggeringly high. Tenants routinely spend large portions of their incomes on tiny apartments tucked away in the far corners of the city. Others cram into crowded basement units just to afford the monthly bill.

In much of the country, rents have fallen over the last few years as

the housing market has stagnated and new homes have become available.

Not here.

In Boston, prices march ever upward, leaving many renters wondering: Will they ever come down?

The short answer, economists say, is not in any meaningful way.

“Boston, no matter what happens, rents go up,” said Paul Willen,

a senior economist with the Federal Reserve Bank of Boston. “If the whole country is going down, Boston is the outlier. If the whole country is going up, Boston is also going up.”

It has been this way in Boston and many of its suburbs for decades, for a few key reasons. The first is that the population of the region has been growing consistently, while construction has not kept pace. Simply put, there are not enough homes for the number of people who live here now.

The second is that Greater Boston’s status as a hub for biotech and higher education, as well as other high-paying industries, keeps demand high. Many workers in those industries earn well over the region’s median income, and can afford to pay higher rents, which drives prices upward.

Together, those two dynamics have put intense pressure on the rental market, enough even that when rents trend downward in other places, they stay high here. Per-

RENTS, Page A10

Summers steps back from posts at Harvard

Bowing to pressure over Epstein ties, he says he’ll stop teaching for now

This story was reported by Aidan Ryan, Claire Thornton, Jim Puzzanghera, Deirdre Fernandes, Tricia L. Nadolny, and Nick Stoico, and written by Ryan.

Larry Summers is immediately stepping back from his teaching duties at Harvard University as the school investigates his ties to convicted sex offender Jeffrey Epstein, a spokesperson for Summers confirmed to the Globe.

Summers is also taking leave from his role as director of the Kennedy School’s Mossavar-Rahmani Center for Business and Government, the spokesperson added.

“Mr. Summers has decided it’s in the best interest of the Center for him to go on leave from his role as Director as Harvard undertakes its review,” the spokesperson said in a statement.

Emails released by a congressional committee last week showed that Summers — who still holds the highest faculty title at Harvard, university professor — maintained close ties to Epstein prior to

► **Summers’ retreat from the business world could be permanent. D1.**

► **Trump signs bill to release files. A2.**

SUMMERS, Page A7

Prosecutors of Comey take a hit in court

By Alan Feuer and Devlin Barrett

NEW YORK TIMES

ALEXANDRIA, Va. — A federal judge grilled the prosecutors pursuing charges against James Comey, the former FBI director, on Wednesday, interrogating them with a series of questions that underscored irregularities in the case, including that the full grand jury did not see the indictment it was supposed to have approved.

The questioning by Judge Michael S. Nachmanoff took place at an excruciatingly awkward hearing in US District Court in Alexandria, Va., that was nominally held to consider the narrow issue of whether the charges against Comey had been filed as an act of vindictive retribution by President Trump.

But Nachmanoff peppered prosecutors with questions on a range of topics, including Trump’s own statements about wanting Comey to be indicted and an earlier decision by career members of the US attorney’s office in Alexandria to forgo bringing charges.

In one remarkable moment, the judge posed some of his questions directly to Lindsey Halligan, the US attorney handpicked by Trump to

COMEY, Page A6



ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

Sugie Ali said a burst pipe at Rosemont Square led to all kinds of issues, such as mold and high bills for repairs.

‘Things started falling apart’

Tenants point to corporate landlords for state of Randolph apartment complexes

By Mara Kardas-Nelson

GLOBE STAFF

RANDOLPH — In late spring last year, water began gushing out of the bathroom at Sugie Ali’s two-bedroom unit at Rosemont Square, a large apartment complex.

“There was contaminated water everywhere,” she recalled.

A burst pipe triggered months of trouble. While waiting for repairs, Ali had no workable kitchen and had to shower in friends’ homes. She suffered

from a chronic respiratory infection that she believes came from mold and the damp, and wound up in and out of the hospital.

She endured this for months, until Rosemont finally put her up in a hotel after she complained to the town’s board of health. She was then moved into a different, smaller apartment at Rosemont, which cost just over \$2,500 a month. She says the landlord tried to bill her nearly \$7,000 for repairs, but dropped it after the state attorney gener-

al’s office stepped in.

Her complaint is one of many that tenants have lodged with the town of Randolph since the 507-unit Rosemont Square was bought in 2020 by Waterton Residential, a Chicago-based real estate investor and property management company. Renters, many of whom live on modest incomes or receive housing subsidies, have repeatedly complained of unmaintained buildings, unresponsive management, and additional fees that

total hundreds, sometimes thousands, of dollars a year.

A Globe review of court documents and records from the town’s health department shows Rosemont Square has the highest number of complaints and housing court cases of all the large apartment complexes in Randolph, a working-class suburb south of Boston where approximately 30 percent of people rent. Randolph also has the highest rate of eviction filings of

RANDOLPH, Page A10

A taste of stardom leaves Boston hungry

Some Michelin recognition but the bar keeps getting higher

A big night for 311 Omakase



The South End spot earned a star but other restaurants went home disappointed. **D1.**

By Devra First

GLOBE STAFF

PHILADELPHIA — On Tuesday night, the Michelin Guide hosted a ceremony for its latest Northeast Cities edition. For the first time, the guide includes Boston and Philadelphia, as well as Chicago,

New York, and Washington, D.C. At the Kimmel Center for the Performing Arts, many of Boston’s top chefs were in attendance. The night looked like it was shaping up to be a good one for the Boston restaurant scene.

And it was. All told, 26 local restau-

rants received Michelin recognition.

Chef Wei Fa Chen’s 311 Omakase received one star from the dining guide, the only one in the Boston-area to receive the designation, which denotes “high quality cooking, worth a stop.”

Omakase-style restaurants offer sushi- and sashimi-focused tasting menus selected by the chef not the diner. Opened in 2023, 311 stands out for its serene space, deeply personal touch, and speakeasy-like location in a South End apartment. It is no surprise Michelin singled out an omakase restaurant for its lone Boston star, as the

MICHELIN, Page A7

A HARDER LINE IN N.C.



RYAN MURPHY/GETTY IMAGES

A person was detained by Border Patrol agents this week as immigration enforcement continued to surge across the Charlotte, N.C., region. Agents are now expanding operations to include Raleigh, the state capital, and nearby Democratic cities. **A2.**

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Suggested retail price
\$4.00



Up town

Thursday: Some sun, warmer.
High 43-48. Low 32-37.

Friday: A bit cloudier.
High 48-53. Low 43-48.

Weather and Comics, D5-6.

Massachusetts could be headed for a sharp uptick in flu cases, as a newly mutated strain is surging in the United Kingdom. **B1.**

The Bruins’ Charlie McAvoy had facial surgery and will be out for the foreseeable future. **C1.**

Russia launched a missile barrage at Ukraine. **A3.**